

Sean Meador

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SUMMARY

Founder and engineering leader with 15+ years building products from zero to scale across consumer and enterprise software. I've grown engineering organizations from first hire to 30+ engineers, developing managers and leading cross-functional teams. I bring a strong product mindset, integrating across the stack to turn data and ML capabilities into thoughtfully designed customer-facing solutions. My recent focus is applying AI to real-world enterprise problems, with production systems that have reduced food waste in grocery by over 200M pounds.

EXPERIENCE

Cherry

Engineering Manager

Aug 2026 – Present · Austin, TX (Remote)

Joined Cherry, a healthcare financing platform that enables providers to offer their patients flexible payment plans, to lead a new product development team in the Provider org. Building zero-to-one products with the goal to help our providers grow their practices and thrive.

Afresh

Principal Engineer

May 2025 – Jul 2026 · San Francisco, CA (Remote)

Transitioned into a Principal Engineer role to lead deep technical projects, provide strategic guidance, and drive AI enablement across a 50-person engineering organization.

- Led org-wide migration of the data platform from Snowflake to Databricks, reducing overall infrastructure costs and consolidating the developer toolchain
- Led cross-team adoption of a new ML ordering framework, improving accuracy and enabling consuming teams to simplify extensive parts of the data model
- Provided technical guidance and oversight for the migration of the primary live database to a highly scalable managed solution
- Built an automated data management system to eliminate storage overruns, significantly reducing operational burden on the engineering team

Director of Product Engineering

Jun 2019 – May 2025 · San Francisco, CA (In Person, Remote)

Grew the Product Engineering function from a team of 1 to 30+ people spanning multiple teams and product lines. Owned all customer-facing applications, working closely with Data, Analytics, and ML teams to integrate their services into our features. Helped grow revenue from 6 to 8 figures while achieving a cumulative 200+ million pounds of food waste prevention.

- Managed cross-functional teams of mobile, full-stack, QA, and product data engineers
- Hired first 15+ engineers and 5 engineering managers, developing them to lead their teams independently
- Expanded store-level ordering and inventory products to include all fresh departments and new device types (scanners)
- Improved system scalability and resiliency to support tens of thousands of store-departments and a large national retailer (Albertsons)
- Created a corporate web portal and data pipelines to enable retailers to manage operational data and view user adherence analytics
- Scaled team structure, processes, and operations to support multiple product lines, on-call rotations, and enterprise SLAs

Lead Product Engineer

Oct 2018 – Jun 2019 · San Francisco, CA

Joined as the 2nd employee and founding engineer at Afresh, an AI-powered solution to optimize grocery store ordering for fresh food departments with the goal of reducing food waste.

- Developed core ordering product from early prototype to enterprise-ready solution deployed at first 3 customers
- Built initial iPad app, API backend, and product data models that laid foundation for years to come
- Worked closely with customers to understand store operations and create tailored solutions

Rakuten Americas

Engineering Manager

Oct 2016 – Oct 2018 · San Mateo, CA

Managed a 5-person team responsible for all mobile applications across platforms with 2M+ total users. Our apps powered a market research business that grew to 8-figure revenue with Fortune 500 customers.

- Owned team roadmap and hired 3 new engineers to support growth
- Collaborated closely with Product & Design to grow user base through new features and delightful experiences
- Led re-platforming of legacy Slice apps to Swift and Kotlin
- Drove the migration of Unroll.Me app to React Native for cross-platform support
- Developed new analytics stack to better measure user behavior and increase conversion rates
- Expanded management scope to include mobile QA and Customer Support functions, owning full customer experience and product quality

Lead Mobile Engineer (Slice)

Nov 2011 – Oct 2016 · San Mateo, CA

Joined e-commerce startup Slice as an early employee to lead all iOS development. Slice was regularly featured as a top package tracking app in the App Store. Slice and Unroll.Me were acquired and merged by Rakuten in 2014.

- Implemented the foundational iOS platform and toolkit, including data caching and syncing layers to support offline usage
- Developed core iOS features for Slice such as purchase and package tracking, refund management, and spending analytics
- Built the Unroll.Me iOS app from scratch, an email management app that achieved top-10 overall App Store ranking and scaled to millions of users

Mozign

Founder & Engineer

May 2010 – Mar 2012 · Dallas, TX

Founded a mobile app consulting company, leading software development of custom mobile apps and full-stack backends for various clients including a Euroleague basketball team, a popular poker website, and local businesses.

- Hired and mentored a 3-person engineering team, managing technical direction and code quality across all client projects
- Managed product and design alongside my cofounder, together owning the full product lifecycle and client engagement

EDUCATION

Stanford University — Graduate Coursework, Computer Science

Sep 2009 – Mar 2010 · Focus in Computer Graphics. TA for CS 106A and CS108.

Stanford University — BS, Computer Science

Sep 2005 – Jun 2009 · Coursework: Computer Graphics, Computer Vision, Machine Learning, Compilers, Networking.

PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

- **Technical Advisor** (2024–2025): Advised early-stage startups The Weet (finance app) and Proxi (social networking)
- **Painted or Printed? Correlation analysis of brickwork...** — Published in SPIE (2009), with Prof. David Stork and Petria Nobel
- **Interactive Lighting of Macro Photography** — Graduate project (2008), with Alexis Chan